greatly increased the number of troops and paramilitaries in Indian-administered Kashmir, and by 1993 they were beginning to get the better of HM and other local groups. The effects of attrition demanded more recruits. Indian counter-insurgency improvements had also made it more difficult to send militants from Indian-administered Kashmir across the LoC for training.[27] Further, beyond mere numbers, what the insurgency really needed were battle-hardened fighters of exactly the sort the Afghan jihad had produced.

In addition, the Indian government augmented the military aspects of its counter-insurgency with social and political reforms designed to win over the Kashmiris. These included steps such as increasing local autonomy, enhancing the legitimacy of local government, increasing spending for development and providing free medical services at military camps. Although the approach was somewhat ad hoc and the security forces continued to engage in brutality against segments of the populace, these measures did help to shrink local support for the insurgency. Shifting patronage to a non-indigenous recruitment base, whose membership would be immune to such reforms, was a means by which the Pakistan army could increase reliable manpower in the region.[28]

Indian forces were also raising local militias consisting of former militants—known as renegades—as well as fresh recruits. Some renegades were lured away by bribery after having lost the Darwinian struggle for funding and weapons. Others were frightened into betrayal by threats the Indian security forces made against them or their families. Still others left the armed struggle out of disillusionment with the militant groups involved in the conflict and their willingness to perpetrate violence against those Kashmiris who did not share their pro-accession or pro-Islamist sentiments.[29] HM, in particular, had acquired a bad reputation for killing members of smaller guerrilla groups in addition to the JKLF's pro-independence supporters. When the Indian army began using these renegades, HM suffered the brunt of this campaign.[30] In addition to killing some HM cadres and leading the Indian security forces to others, renegades also began targeting the families of HM militants, leading additional cadres to desert.[31] The ISI sought to mitigate this by introducing non-indigenous militants with no families or history in the region.